crippled because of the lack of senior officers.[19] In India, Gen. Bucher put a lid on this issue and acquiesced to compromising on India's interests. He also toned down the plans for offensive operations and use of the Royal Indian Air Force, which was proposed by Indian generals.[20]Bucher was clearly a Trojan horse in the Indian Army who, in hindsight, deserved to have charges of high treason filed against him.[21]

In London, the Foreign Office was primed to resolve and resist all Indian enquiries on this subject by bluffing and presenting every argument that they could muster. The reason for this was that Gen. Gracey was stubbornly opposed to stepping down and was not bothered about embarrassing the British Government in the process.[22] Gracey's zealousness had no boundaries. In July 1948, Whitehall was further shocked to learn that a dozen British officers from the Pakistan Army were fighting in Kashmir.[23] India, on the other hand, was restrained by Gen. Bucher as he was anxious about going into direct combat with Pakistan. He used his influence to stop moderating and diminish the initiatives of Indian commanders on the field and at the planning level.[24] Mountbatten encouraged Bucher, along with Air Chief Marshall Elmhirst, to remain in personal touch with Nehru and manipulate him from taking any aggressive action that might put Pakistan at risk.[25]Gen. Bucher constantly harped on having military operations that are linked to political policies.

However, Gen. Gracey's aggressive policy soon faced repercussions. One of the British officers in the Pakistan Army fighting in Kashmir, Maj. R. E. Sloan was killed on Saturday 10 July 1948 in the Tithwal sector while commanding 71 Field Company, Royal Pakistan Engineers.[26] Whitehall strove to hush this mishap.[27] Secretary of State for Commonwealth Affairs, Philip Noel-Baker advised Attlee against enforcing the stepping down of officers, and argued that it would remove the influence of moderation by India and it would be impossible for Pakistan to run its army without British officers.[28] Noel-Baker was supported by Grafftey-Smith who delivered assurances that no British officer would be posted on actual battlefields in Kashmir, thereafter.[29]